

Literature Review

Annotated bibliography — the sourcing backbone for every claim on this site.

Working draft, subject to revision.

Sources are grouped by the role they play in the argument. Each entry carries a one-line note on how the study uses it. Links were resolving as of the updated date above.

Foundational theory

Charland, Maurice. "Constitutive Rhetoric: The Case of the Peuple Québécois." *Quarterly Journal of Speech* 73, no. 2 (1987): 133–150. doi.org/10.1080/00335638709383799 The master apparatus for the whole project: rhetoric calls a "people" into being and embeds a telos in the act of constituting it.

Burke, Kenneth. *A Rhetoric of Motives*. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1950. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/A_Rhetoric_of_Motives Supplies identification (consubstantiality), the first of the two engines Charland fuses into constitutive rhetoric.

Althusser, Louis. "Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses." In *Lenin and Philosophy and Other Essays*, 1970. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ideology_and_Ideological_State_Apparatuses Supplies interpellation, the "hailing" by which a discourse seats a subject in a position before that subject can refuse it.

McGee, Michael Calvin. "In Search of 'the People': A Rhetorical Alternative." *Quarterly Journal of Speech* 61, no. 3 (1975): 235–249. doi.org/10.1080/00335637509383289 Establishes "the people" as a rhetorical achievement rather than a pre-existing fact, the premise the three cases stress-test.

The Québec case

“1980 Quebec referendum.” Wikipedia. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1980Quebecreferendum The first sovereignty-association vote and the immediate context for Charland’s 1987 analysis; defeated 59.6% to 40.4%.

“1995 Referendum on Québec’s Accession to Sovereignty.” Élections Québec. electionsquebec.qc.ca Official results for the near-miss of October 30, 1995 (No 50.58%, Yes 49.42%); the case where a thick ethnos came one point from a forward telos.

Grand Council of the Crees. Sovereign Injustice (1995); see also “Grand Council of the Crees.” Wikipedia. [en.wikipedia.org/wiki/GrandCounciloftheCre es](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/GrandCounciloftheCrees) Records the Cree counter-referendum of October 24, 1995 (96.3% to remain in Canada): a prior people refusing constitution into someone else’s “people.”

Supreme Court of Canada. Reference re Secession of Quebec, \[1998\] 2 SCR 217. decisions.scc-csc.ca/.../item/1643 Holds that unilateral secession is unconstitutional but that a clear majority on a clear question obliges negotiation: the juridical frame both later cases run into.

The Alberta 2026 case

“2026 Alberta referendum.” Wikipedia. [en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026Albertareferendu m](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026Albertareferendum) Overview of the October 19, 2026 multi-question referendum and the separation question’s path onto the ballot.

Trynacity, Kim. “Alberta premier, cabinet formalize wording of Oct. 19 separation question.” CBC News, 2026. cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/...9.7215485 Primary source for the exact ballot wording: a two-option, non-binding question about commencing a legal process, not a direct vote to separate.

Smith, Danielle. "Premier's Address to the Province." Alberta.ca, 2025. alberta.ca/premiers-address-to-the-province The government's own framing of grievance and identity, read as the constitutive appeal under analysis.

"Alberta Sovereignty within a United Canada Act," SA 2022. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/AlbertaSovereigntywithinUnitedCanadaAct The title itself is the evidence for the detachable telos: a sovereignty claim held expressly "within a united Canada."

Wakefield, Jonny. "Judge overturns Alberta's approval of separation referendum petition." CBC News, May 13, 2026. cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/...9.7198553 Reports the King's Bench ruling (Justice Shaina Leonard) quashing the petition for failure of the Crown's duty to consult.

JFK Law. "Treaty Rights and Alberta Separatism: The Crown's Duty to Consult in Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation v Alberta (Chief Electoral Officer)." 2026. jfklaw.ca/treaty-rights-and-alberta-separatism... Legal analysis of the ruling: separation would adversely affect Treaty 7 and 8 rights, so the electoral step itself triggered the duty to consult.

"Numbered Treaties." Wikipedia. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/NumberedTreaties Establishes that Treaties 6, 7, and 8 (1876–1899) predate Alberta's creation in 1905: a prior peoplehood with a standing juridical claim.

Angus Reid Institute. "Alberta Separation: Three-in-five say they'd vote in October to stay, but half say the question is 'confusing.'" 2026. angusreid.org/alberta-referendum-question Polling showing the identity and the secessionist conclusion come apart: roughly 60% would vote No on the official question (about 35% Yes), and 67% choose to stay on a plain leave/stay framing.

The US “true America” framing

“No Kings protests.” Wikipedia. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/NoKingsprotests Documents the 2025–2026 mobilizations whose “restore the real America” register supplies the restorationist (backward-vector) case.

“3.5% rule.” Wikipedia. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/3.5%\rule The threshold claim the movement invokes about itself; used here as a self-constituting number, a “people” asserting its own scale.

Chenoweth, Erica. “The 3.5% Rule: Understanding What Makes Protest Powerful.” Harvard Kennedy School. hks.harvard.edu/.../35-rule The scholarship behind the figure (Chenoweth and Stephan), distinguishing the empirical finding from its rhetorical redeployment.